

DRAFT California State Water Resources Control Board’s Guide to Publishing on the California Open Data Portal

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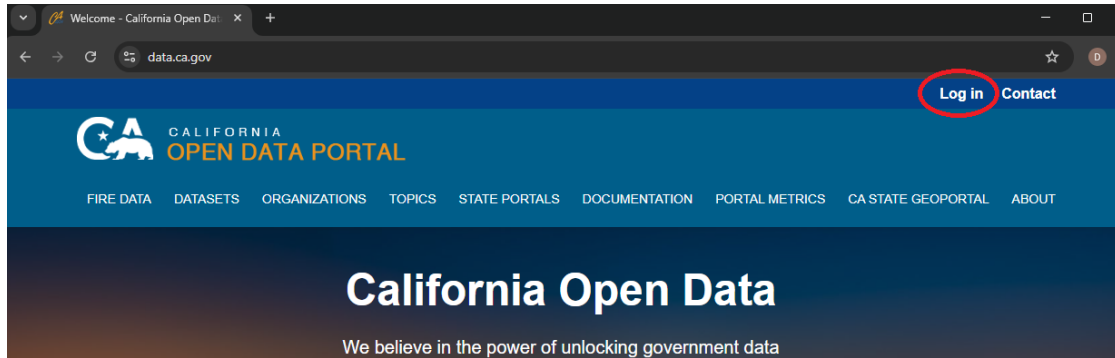
1 Introduction

This document describes the basics of how to publish and maintain a dataset on the [California Open Data Portal](#) for staff at the California State Water Resources Control Board. In the context of the California Open Data Portal, a dataset is a collection of data resources (which are files or links to files containing data, such as CSV files), together with a description and other supporting information (metadata), at a fixed URL.

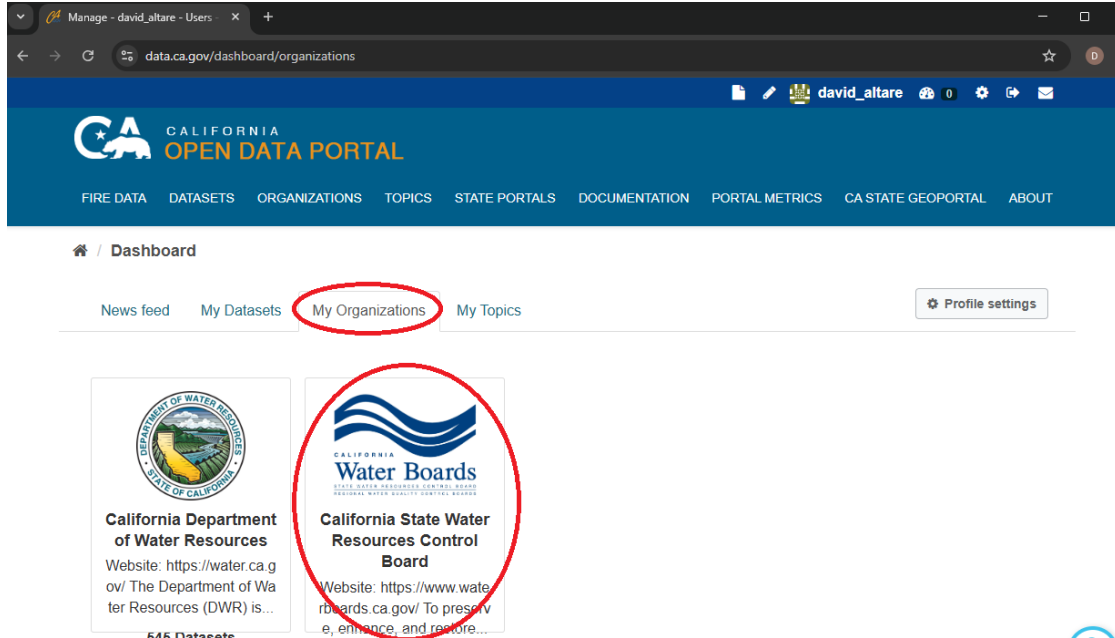
The instructions below demonstrate how to create a new dataset, then add one or more data resources to that dataset. If you want to manage an existing dataset (including adding a new data resource, updating an existing data resource, or editing dataset metadata), skip to the [Managing an Existing Dataset or Data Resource](#) section.

2 Creating a New Dataset

1. Go to <https://data.ca.gov> and click on the **Log in** button at the top right of the window to log in to your user account. (NOTE: if you don't already have an account on the data.ca.gov portal, you'll need to contact Office of Information Management and Analysis (OIMA) staff to create an account and get added to the Water Board's organizational account.)



2. In your account dashboard, click on the **My Organizations** tab, then click on the **California State Water Resources Control Board** icon (NOTE: you should be automatically taken to the dashboard page after logging in to your account; you can also access the dashboard page by clicking on the dashboard icon (which looks like a speed dial) in the upper right side of the data.ca.gov webpage, next to your user name).



3. On the organization page, click on the **Add Dataset** button.

The screenshot shows a web browser window with the URL `data.ca.gov/organization/california-state-water-resources-control-board`. The page header includes the "CALIFORNIA OPEN DATA PORTAL" logo and a navigation menu with links: FIRE DATA, DATASETS, ORGANIZATIONS, TOPICS, STATE PORTALS, DOCUMENTATION, PORTAL METRICS, CA STATE GEOPORTAL, and ABOUT. The breadcrumb trail indicates the current location: `/ Organizations / California State Water...`.

On the left, there is a sidebar for the "California State Water Resources Control Board" with its logo and a brief description of its mission. A "read more" link is provided at the bottom of the sidebar.

The main content area features a tabbed interface with "Datasets", "Activity Stream", and "About". The "Datasets" tab is active, and the "Add Dataset" button is highlighted with a red circle. Below the tabs is a search bar labeled "Search datasets..." and a dropdown menu set to "Order by: Relevance".

The results section displays "66 datasets found". The first dataset listed is "Drinking Water - SAFER Dashboard Failing and At-Risk Drinking Water Systems", with a brief description: "The Division of Drinking Water (DDW) identifies Failing and At-Risk community water systems and K-12 non-transient, non-community schools. This information is displayed online..." and a circular icon with a question mark.

4. Fill in the dataset metadata (e.g., Title, Description, etc.). Guidance on how to populate the metadata is available [here](#) and [here](#).

The screenshot shows a web browser window with the URL `data.ca.gov/dataset/new?group=a652035f-505c-4c24-8464-fed3623acfd`. The page header is blue with the California Open Data Portal logo and navigation links: FIRE DATA, DATASETS, ORGANIZATIONS, TOPICS, STATE PORTALS, DOCUMENTATION, PORTAL METRICS, CA STATE GEOPORTAL, and ABOUT. The breadcrumb trail is `/ Datasets / Create Dataset`. The main content area has a two-step progress bar: **1 Create dataset** (active) and **2 Add data**. On the left, a sidebar titled "What are datasets?" explains that a CKAN Dataset is a collection of data resources with a description and other information at a fixed URL. The main form has three sections: **Title:** with a text input field containing "eg. A descriptive title"; **URL:** with a text input field containing "data.ca.gov/dataset/<dataset>" and an "Edit" button; and **Description:** with a large text area containing "eg. Some useful notes about the data". A footer note states "You can use Markdown formatting here".

What are datasets?

A CKAN Dataset is a collection of data resources (such as files), together with a description and other information, at a fixed URL. Datasets are what users see when searching for data.

1 Create dataset **2 Add data**

*** Title:**

eg. A descriptive title

*** URL:** data.ca.gov/dataset/<dataset> [Edit](#)

*** Description:**

eg. Some useful notes about the data

You can use Markdown formatting here

NOTE: Use the **Visibility** dropdown menu to control whether or not your dataset is publicly accessible. Use the **Private** option to restrict visibility of your dataset to only other users of the Water Board's organizational account on the Open Data Portal (this is useful when drafting your dataset prior to publication), or use the **Public** option to make your dataset accessible to the general public.

Topic :

For data curation purposes users should be a member of a topic to add a dataset to the topic

* **Publisher:**

Visibility:

Private

Private

Public

Public

* **Rights:**

* **Program Contact Name:**

When you're finished, click on the **Next: Add Data** button at the bottom of the page.

Custom Field:

Key: Value:

Custom Field:

Key: Value:

Custom Field:

Key: Value:

The data license you select above only applies to the contents of any resource files that you add to this dataset. By submitting this form, you agree to release the metadata values that you enter into the form under the [Open Database License](#).

* Required field

Next: Add Data

5. Add a file containing your data using either the **Upload** or **Link** buttons, add a title and description for the resource, then click the **Finish** button, or click the **Save & add another** button to add another data resource. Guidance on how to format a data file for publication on the open data portal is available [here](#) and [here](#).

California OPEN DATA PORTAL

FIRE DATA DATASETS ORGANIZATIONS TOPICS STATE PORTALS DOCUMENTATION PORTAL METRICS CA STATE GEOPORTAL ABOUT

Organizations / California State Water... / Example Dataset / Edit / Add New Resource

1 Create dataset 2 Add data

File:

Upload **Link**

Title:

eg. January 2015 Gold Prices

Description:

Some useful notes about the data

You can use Markdown formatting here

Format:

eg. CSV, XML or JSON

Previous **Save & add another** **Finish**

6. Add a data dictionary for the data resource you just created using one or both of the following methods:

- A: Upload a PDF containing the data dictionary as a separate resource in the dataset
- B: Add the data dictionary directly to the data resource's page (the data dictionary will appear below the data table)

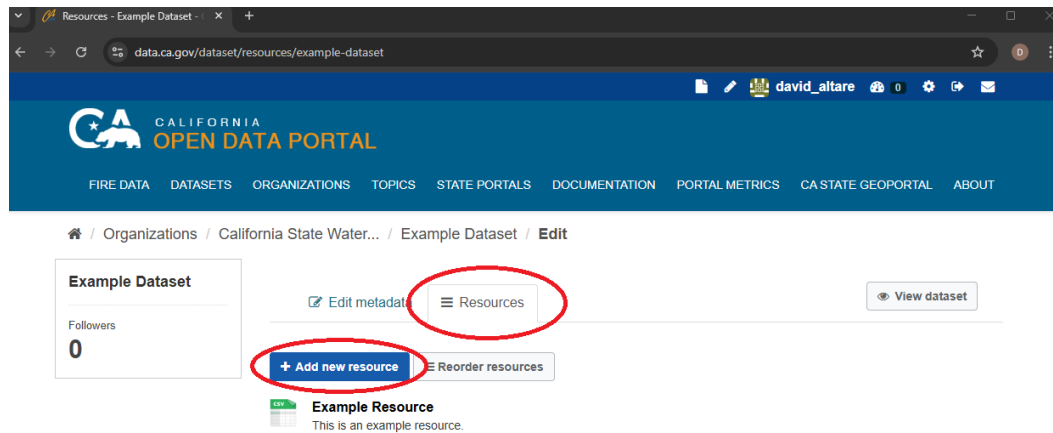
Guidance on how to populate the data dictionary is available [here](#), [here](#), and [here](#).

- A. Upload a PDF containing the data dictionary to the dataset (as a separate resource), by going to the dataset homepage and clicking on the **Manage** button.

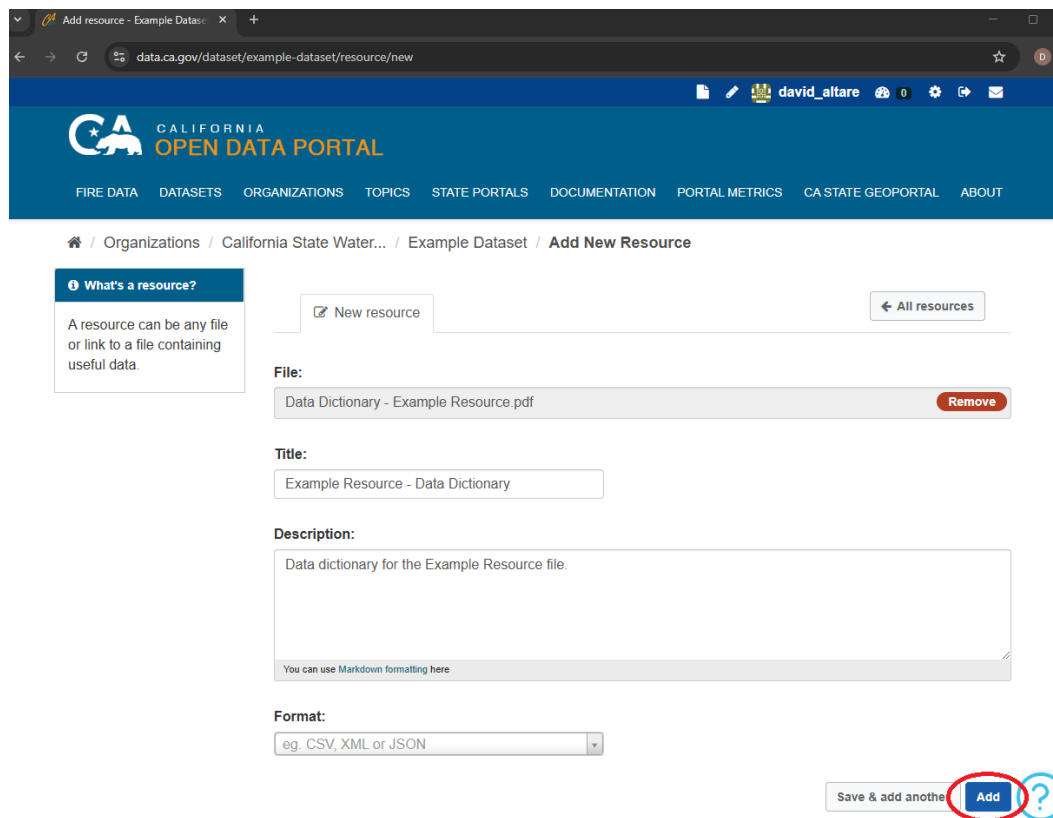
The screenshot shows the 'Example Dataset' page on the California Open Data Portal. The page is titled 'Example Dataset' and is marked as 'PRIVATE'. It features a 'Manage' button circled in red in the top right corner. The page includes a 'Data and Resources' section with an 'Example Resource' and a search bar containing the word 'water'. Below this is an 'Additional Info' section with a 'Download' button and a table of metadata.

Field	Value
Public Access Level	Public
Rights	No restrictions on public use
Program Contact Name	Contact Name
Program Contact Email	waterdata@waterboards.ca.gov

Then click on the **Resources** tab, and click on the **Add new resource** button.



Upload the PDF file by clicking the **Upload** button, then click on the **Add** button.



- B. Add the data dictionary directly to the data resource by going to the data resource's page and clicking on the **Manage** button. (**NOTE:** After uploading a new data resource, before you can add data dictionary information you'll need to wait until the data table appears on the resource's page, as shown in the screenshot below; this could take a few minutes, depending on the size of the resource.)

The screenshot shows the 'Example Resource' page on the California Open Data Portal. The page has a blue header with the portal logo and navigation links. Below the header, the breadcrumb trail is 'Organizations / California State Water... / Example Dataset / Example Resource'. The main content area features a 'Manage' button circled in red, along with 'Setup for Reporting', 'DataStore', 'Download', and 'Data API' buttons. Below these buttons, the URL is displayed: <https://data.ca.gov/dataset/862443bb-e5c3-4ee0-9bac-44771c406b09/resource/194a9af0-4111-4472-a64c-b891b0652f2f/download/penguins...>. Below the URL, there is a 'Data Table' button and a 'Canonical View' button. Further down, there is an 'Add Filter' button, a 'Show 10 entries' dropdown, and a 'Hide/Unhide Columns' button. At the bottom, there is a search bar and a table with 9 columns: _id, species, island, bill_length_mm, bill_depth_mm, flipper_length_mm, body_mass_g, sex, and year. The table contains 3 rows of data.

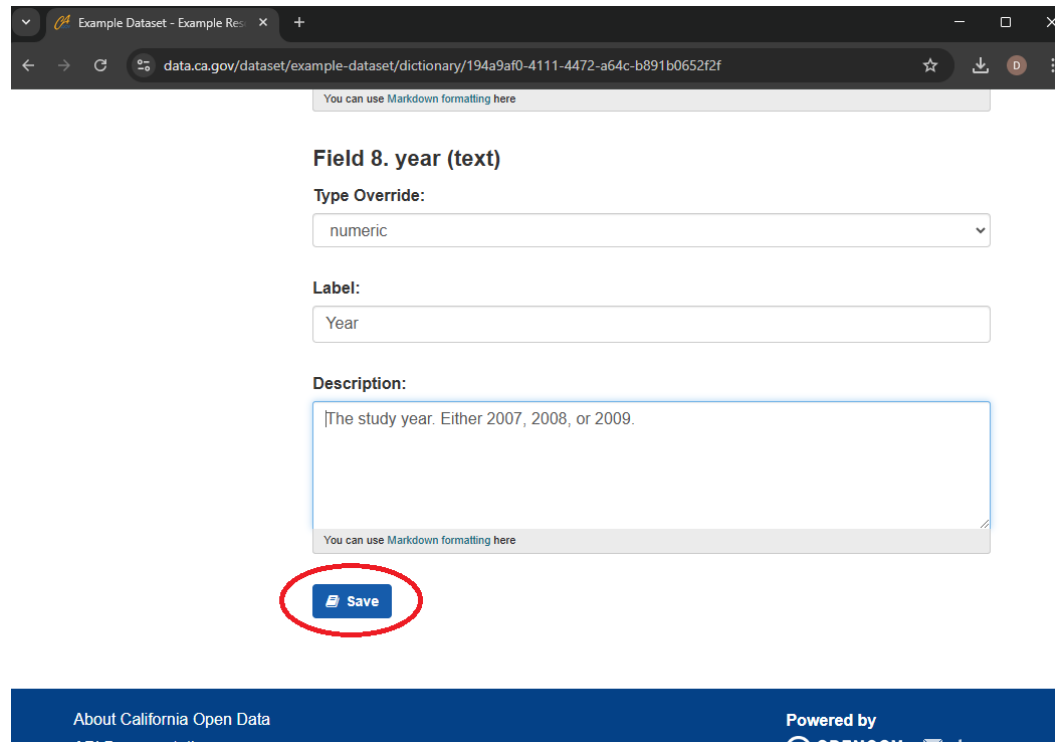
_id	species	island	bill_length_mm	bill_depth_mm	flipper_length_mm	body_mass_g	sex	year
1	Adelie	Torgersen	39.1	18.7	181	3750	male	2007
2	Adelie	Torgersen	39.5	17.4	186	3800	female	2007
3	Adelie	Torgersen	40.3	18	195	3250	female	2007

Go to the **Data Dictionary** tab, then fill in the available information for each field in the data resource.

The screenshot shows a web browser window with the URL `data.ca.gov/dataset/example-dataset/dictionary/194a9af0-4111-4472-a64c-b891b0652f2f`. The page header includes the California Open Data Portal logo and navigation links: FIRE DATA, DATASETS, ORGANIZATIONS, TOPICS, STATE PORTALS, DOCUMENTATION, PORTAL METRICS, CA STATE GEOPORTAL, and ABOUT. The breadcrumb trail is: Home / Organizations / California State Water... / Example Dataset / Example Resource / Edit. On the left, a sidebar shows 'Example Resource' with a 'Format' dropdown set to 'CSV'. The main content area has tabs: 'Edit resource', 'DataStore', 'Data Dictionary' (highlighted with a red circle), 'Setup for Reporting', and 'Views'. Above the 'Data Dictionary' tab are buttons for 'All resources' and 'View resource'. The 'Data Dictionary' tab contains the following fields:

- Field 1. species (text)**
- Type Override:** A dropdown menu.
- Label:** A text input field.
- Description:** A large text area with a note at the bottom: 'You can use Markdown formatting here'.

Click the **Save** button when finished.



The screenshot shows a web browser window with the URL `data.ca.gov/dataset/example-dataset/dictionary/194a9af0-4111-4472-a64c-b891b0652f2f`. The page displays a form for editing a dataset field. At the top, a notification bar states "You can use Markdown formatting here". The form is titled "Field 8. year (text)". It includes a "Type Override:" dropdown menu currently set to "numeric", a "Label:" text input field containing "Year", and a "Description:" text area containing the text "The study year. Either 2007, 2008, or 2009." Below the description field, another notification bar says "You can use Markdown formatting here". A blue "Save" button with a floppy disk icon is circled in red. The footer of the page is dark blue and contains the text "About California Open Data" and "Powered by" followed by the "OPENGOV" logo.

Field 8. year (text)

Type Override:
numeric

Label:
Year

Description:
The study year. Either 2007, 2008, or 2009.

You can use Markdown formatting here

Save

About California Open Data
API Documentation

Powered by
OPENGOV

After saving the data dictionary information, the data dictionary will appear below the data table on the resource's page. (**NOTE:** you may need to update the resource's **DataStore** to make sure all of the changes to the data dictionary are applied to the resource; to do this, see the instructions in [Step 2](#) of the *Managing an Existing Dataset or Data Resource* section below.)

_id	species	island	bill_length_mm	bill_depth_mm	flipper_length_mm	body_mass_g	sex	year
1	Adelie	Torgersen	39.1	18.7	181	3750	male	2007
2	Adelie	Torgersen	39.5	17.4	186	3800	female	2007
3	Adelie	Torgersen	40.3	18	195	3250	female	2007
4	Adelie	Torgersen	NaN	NaN	NaN	NaN	NA	2007
5	Adelie	Torgersen	36.7	19.3	193	3450	female	2007
6	Adelie	Torgersen	39.3	20.6	190	3650	male	2007
7	Adelie	Torgersen	38.9	17.8	181	3625	female	2007
8	Adelie	Torgersen	39.2	19.6	195	4675	male	2007
9	Adelie	Torgersen	34.1	18.1	193	3475	NA	2007
10	Adelie	Torgersen	42	20.2	190	4250	NA	2007

Showing 1 to 10 of 344 entries

Previous 1 2 3 4 5 ... 35 Next

Column	Type	Label	Description
species	text	Species	The penguin's species. Either Adelie, Chinstrap, or Gentoo.
island	text	Island	The island in Palmer Archipelago, Antarctica where the penguin was observed. Either Biscoe, Dream, or Torgersen.
bill_length_mm	numeric	Bill Length (mm)	The penguin's bill length in millimeters.
bill_depth_mm	numeric	Bill Depth (mm)	The penguin's bill depth in millimeters.

NOTE: Setting the data type for each field by selecting a value in the **Type Override** box is especially useful if your users will be accessing the data via the API, but you'll need to ensure that all of the data in the given field is compatible with that data type before setting a data type other than 'text'. If there are problems with the data types, you can find more information by following the instructions in [Step 2](#) of the *Managing an Existing Dataset or Data Resource* section below, and going to the **DataStore** tab.

If you need to add data dictionary information for data resources with many fields and/or datasets with large numbers of resources, you can contact OIMA staff for assistance with automating the process of uploading that data dictionary information (to avoid the need for manual entry of the data dictionary information).

3 Managing an Existing Dataset or Data Resource

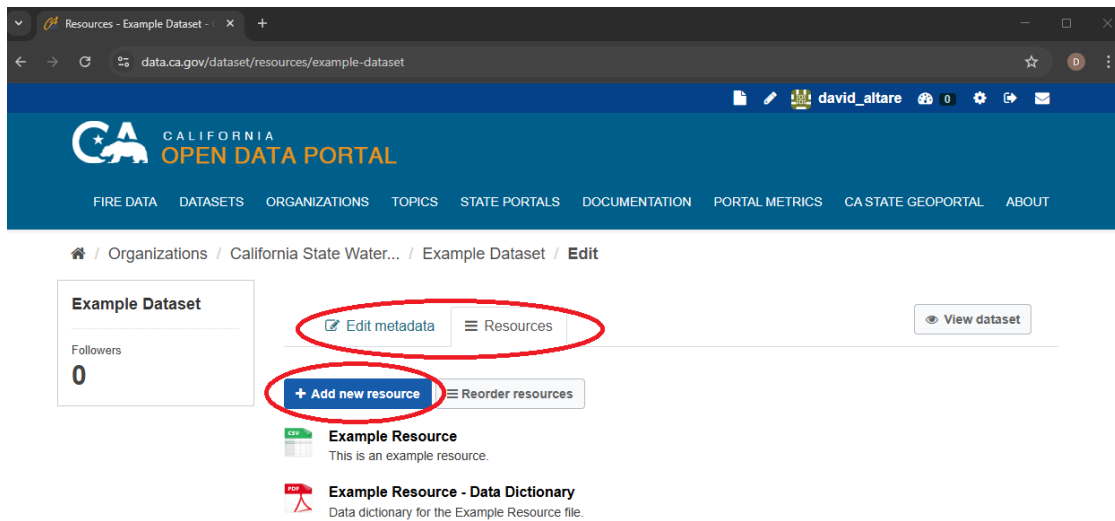
3.1 Update Dataset Metadata or Add Additional Data Resource

To add an additional data resource to an existing dataset, or to update the metadata for an existing dataset:

1. Go to the dataset and click on the **Manage** button.

The screenshot shows the California Open Data Portal interface. The top navigation bar includes links for FIRE DATA, DATASETS, ORGANIZATIONS, TOPICS, STATE PORTALS, DOCUMENTATION, PORTAL METRICS, CA STATE GEOPORTAL, and ABOUT. The user is logged in as 'david_altare'. The breadcrumb trail indicates the location: / Organizations / California State Water... / Example Dataset. The left sidebar shows the 'Example Dataset' details, including 0 followers and a 'Follow' button. The main content area displays the 'Example Dataset' title, a 'PRIVATE' status, and a 'Test description'. Below this, the 'Data and Resources' section lists two resources: 'Example Resource' (CSV) and 'Example Resource - Data Dictionary' (PDF), each with an 'Explore' button. A search bar contains the text 'water'. The 'Additional Info' section has a 'Download' button. At the bottom, a table with headers 'Field' and 'Value' is partially visible.

2. To update the dataset's metadata, click on the **Edit metadata** tab. To add a new data resource to the dataset click on the **Resources** tab then click on the **Add new resource** button.



If you're adding a new data resource that doesn't already have an associated data dictionary available on the portal, you'll need to add a data dictionary for your resource. See [Step #6](#) above for information on how to do this.

3.2 Manage Existing Data Resource

To manage an existing data resource (i.e., an existing file within a dataset and/or the file's associated metadata):

1. Go to the data resource's page, then click on the **Manage** button.

The screenshot shows the California Open Data Portal interface. The header includes the CA logo and navigation links: FIRE DATA, DATASETS, ORGANIZATIONS, TOPICS, STATE PORTALS, DOCUMENTATION, PORTAL METRICS, CA STATE GEOPORTAL, and ABOUT. The breadcrumb trail is: Home / Organizations / California State Water... / Example Dataset / **Example Resource**. Below the breadcrumb, there are four buttons: 'Setup for Reporting', 'DataStore', 'Manage' (circled in red), and 'Download'. To the right of 'Download' is a 'Data API' button. The main content area shows the title 'Example Resource' and a URL: <https://data.ca.gov/dataset/862443bb-e5c3-4ee0-9bac-44771c406b09/resource/194a9af0-4111-4472-a64c-b891b0652f2f/download/penguins...>. Below the URL, it says 'This is an example resource.' There are two tabs: 'Data Table' (selected) and 'Canonical View'. To the right of the tabs are 'Fullscreen' and 'Embed' buttons. Below the tabs, there is an 'Add Filter' button. Below that, it says 'Show 10 entries' and 'Showing 1 to 10 of 344 entries'. To the right of this is a 'Hide/Unhide Columns' button and a search bar. Below the search bar is a table with 9 columns: _id, species, island, bill_length_mm, bill_depth_mm, flipper_length_mm, body_mass_g, sex, and year. The table contains 3 rows of data.

_id	species	island	bill_length_mm	bill_depth_mm	flipper_length_mm	body_mass_g	sex	year
1	Adelle	Torgersen	39.1	18.7	181	3750	male	2007
2	Adelle	Torgersen	39.5	17.4	186	3800	female	2007
3	Adelle	Torgersen	40.0	18.0	190	3900	female	2007

2. Go to the **Edit Resource** tab to update the data file or update the resource's title or description, go to the **DataStore** tab to ensure that the data has been correctly uploaded to the database that feeds the resource's API, or go to the **Data Dictionary** tab to add information about each field and set the fields' data types.

The screenshot shows the 'Edit Resource' page on the California Open Data Portal. The browser address bar displays the URL: `data.ca.gov/dataset/example-dataset/resource/194a9af0-4111-4472-a64c-b891b0652f2f/edit`. The page header includes the 'CALIFORNIA OPEN DATA PORTAL' logo and navigation links: FIRE DATA, DATASETS, ORGANIZATIONS, TOPICS, STATE PORTALS, DOCUMENTATION, PORTAL METRICS, CA STATE GEOPORTAL, and ABOUT. The breadcrumb trail indicates the path: Home / Organizations / California State Water... / Example Dataset / Example Resource / Edit.

On the left sidebar, under 'Example Resource', the format is listed as 'Format CSV'. The main content area features a horizontal tab bar with the following tabs: 'All resources', 'View resource', 'Edit resource' (highlighted with a red oval), 'DataStore', 'Data Dictionary', 'Setup for Reporting', and 'Views'.

The 'Edit resource' tab contains the following fields and controls:

- File:** A text input field containing 'penguins.csv' with a 'Remove' button to its right.
- Title:** A text input field containing 'Example Resource'.
- Description:** A large text area containing 'This is an example resource.' with a note at the bottom: 'You can use Markdown formatting here'.
- Format:** A dropdown menu currently set to 'CSV'.

At the bottom of the page, there are three buttons: 'Delete' (red), 'Update Resource' (blue), and a help icon (blue question mark).

4 Additional Resources

For more information about publishing open data resources on the California Open Data Portal, see the following resources:

- [California Open Data Publisher's Handbook](#)
- [California Open Data Portal Publisher's Guide](#)
- [California State Water Board's Open Data Publishing Guide](#)
- [California State Water Board's Recommendations and Guidelines for Data Dictionary Development](#)
- [California State Water Board's Open Data Handbook](#)